

Syllabus – MGTP 452 Strategic Cost Management & New Technologies

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Rady School of Management

Note: The syllabus may be subject to minor changes regarding its outline.

Course Information

Course Number	MGTP 452
Course Title	Strategic Cost Management & New Technologies
Quarter	Spring 2026
Class meetings	Monday, 9:00am to 11:50am
Classroom	Otterson Hall 1E106

Contact Information

Professor	Mario Milone
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Teaching Assistant	TBD ()
Office Hours	TBD

Textbooks and Readings

Textbook	<i>Managerial Accounting: Making Decisions and Motivating Performance</i> by S. Datar and M. Rajan Pearson, 2014, ISBN 978-0-13-702487-2
Case Studies	See the outline below.

Course Description

This course focuses on the use of internal accounting system for budgeting, planning and decision-making. The first part of the course will provide the vocabulary and tools needed to the understanding of costs, planning, budgeting and pricing decisions. The second part of the course will focus on how to extract relevant information for performance evaluation and control.

The vocabulary and skills developed in this course are essential for managers, consultants, accountants, as they provide a better understanding of the organization's internal operations. Being able to extract and analyze relevant accounting information for decision-making purposes is extremely valuable and applicable in many settings, including finance, accounting, marketing, operations and strategy.

The concepts will be both introduced in class as well as practiced and discussed through an extensive set of case studies.

Course Objectives

At the close of this course, you will be able to:

- Understand the different cost concepts.
- Perform simple and complex cost analyses.
- Understand pricing decisions.
- Perform profitability analyses.
- Understand performance evaluations.
- Understand transfer pricing and its implications.

Course Preparation and Requirements

The course is heavily based on the use of case studies that students need to prepare every week as assignments. The concepts used in each case study is presented in class before the assignments (one or two weeks before). The outline below precises which concepts are used for each case study ("Topic case study"). Students are required to read the book chapters mentioned in the outline (see below) **before** the class. This requirement also holds for the first session of the course. Therefore, **students are required to read chapters 1, 2, 4 & 5 before the course starts.**

Course Evaluation

Evaluation in this course will be based on group case studies and a final individual case study. Additionally, students are expected to attend classes and participate. The final grade will be determined as follows:

1 Attendance	See below
2 Participation	20%
3 Group Case Studies	40%
4 Final Individual Case Study	40%

1 Attendance

Attendance is required for this course. Students are expected to be on time and attendance will be recorded at the beginning of each session. Attendance will determine the maximum final letter grade that can be achieved, regardless of the grades received for participation, group case studies, or final case study. The table below explains the correspondance between the number of attended classes and the maximum letter grade. For example, if a student is present for 7 classes, she/he cannot be awarded a letter grade higher than B+ even if she/he receives full grades for participation, group case studies, and the final exam. Letter grades are first awarded based on the grading of participation, assignments, and final exam according to the table above, and will be capped by the student's attendance. The maximum letter grade of A+ will only be awarded to students that attend at least 8 classes out of 10 (if the grades received for participation, assignments and final exam are high enough).

Number of attended classes	Maximum Letter Grade
8 or more	A+
Between 6 and 8	B+
Between 4 and 6	C+
Between 2 and 4	D+
Less than 2	F

2 Participation

Participation is defined as the amount and quality of interactions that a student will generate during class. Given that this course is heavily based on case studies, the quality of the course depends on students engaging in constructive discussions in the classroom.

3 Group Case Assignments

Students are required to prepare cases and hand-in written assignments at every class (except the first one). For each case, the assignment with questions will be posted on Canvas the week before. These questions are designed to help students understand the case and ensure that they are ready to discuss the case during class. Assignments can be done by groups of maximum 4 students and should be prepared as a *single PDF document*. The document should be kept as brief as possible. When applicable, an appendix containing quantitative analyses can be included. Assignments should be uploaded to Canvas *before* the beginning of the class. They will be graded with a numerical grade between 0 and 100. While 9 assignments will be required and graded, only the 7 highest grades will determine the overall score for the group case studies. **Note, however, that any assignment that is not submitted will have the lowest grade of 0 and will count in the overall score for the group case studies.**

4 Final Case Study

The final exam will be in the form of a case study that students will have to individually analyse in its entirety. More information will be provided as we approach the end of quarter.

Dynamics of the syllabus

In order to promote the best learnings experience, this syllabus is subject to changes as the course progresses. Any change will be made in the interest of the students.

Course Outline

Part I – Cost Accounting and Decision Making

Session 1 – Introduction and Concepts & Product Costing

March 30

Reading Chapters 1, 2, 4 & 5
Case Study No Case Study this week

- Part I: Introduction and Concepts (chapters 1 & 2)
- Part II: Product Costing (chapters 4 & 5)

Session 2 – CVP Analysis

April 6

Reading Chapters 3 & 8
Case Study Precision Worldwide (Topic: *Relevant Costs*)

Session 3 – Activity Based Costing

April 13

Reading Chapter 6
Case Study Bridgeton Industries (Topic: *Product Costing*)

Session 4 – Pricing Decisions

April 20

Reading Chapter 7
Case Study Seligram (Topic: *CVP Analysis*)

Part II – Performance Evaluation and Control

Session 5 – Profitability Analysis

April 27

Reading Chapter 14
Case Study Wilkerson (Topic: *Activity Based Costing*)

Session 6 – Variance Analysis

May 4

Reading Chapters 13
Case Study Owens & Minor (A) (Topic: *Pricing Decisions*)

Session 7 – Control and Performance Evaluation

May 11

Reading Chapters 16
Case Study Store 24 (Topic: *Profitability Analysis*)

Session 8 – Case Study: Compagnie du Froid

May 18

Reading NA
Case Study Compagnie du Froid (Topic: *Variance Analysis*)

Session 9 – No class (Memorial Day)

May 25

Reading Chapter 15
Case Study Vyaderm (Topic: *Control and Performance Evaluation*)

Session 10 – Transfer Pricing

June 1

Reading Chapter 15
Case Study Birch Paper Company (Topic: *Transfer Pricing*)

Academic Integrity

Integrity of scholarship is essential for an academic community. As members of the Rady School, we pledge ourselves to uphold the highest ethical standards. The University expects that both faculty and students will honor this principle and in so doing protect the validity of University intellectual work. For students, this means that all academic work will be done by the individual to whom it is assigned, without unauthorized aid of any kind. **Unauthorized aid includes the use of the internet, artificial intelligence tools such as Large Language Models (LLMs) or any other resources that can help find answers to any of the assignments or final exam (UCSD Policy on Integrity and Scholarship section I.A.a).**

The complete UCSD Policy on Integrity of Scholarship can be viewed at: <http://senate.ucsd.edu/Operating-Procedures/Senate-Manual/Appendices/2>

Upon any suspicion of cheating, an allegation report will be submitted to the academic integrity (AI) office.

You can find out more about the process at: <https://academicintegrity.ucsd.edu/process/>

Students with disabilities

A student who has a disability or special need and requires an accommodation in order to have equal access to the classroom must register with the Office for Students with Disabilities (OSD). The OSD will determine what accommodations may be made and provide the necessary documentation to present to the faculty member.

The student must present the OSD letter of certification and OSD accommodation recommendation to the appropriate faculty member in order to initiate the request for accommodation in classes, examinations, or other academic program activities. No accommodations can be implemented retroactively.

Please visit the [OSD website](#) for further information or contact the Office for Students with Disabilities at (858) 534-4382 or osd@ucsd.edu.